

# Internal Knowledge Handbook

A confidential reference guide to company structure, products, policies, and active projects.

## 1. About NovaTech Innovations

### 1.1 Company History

NovaTech Innovations was founded in 2011 by three former university labmates who set out to build software that removed repetitive work from everyday business operations. The company's first product, a lightweight reporting tool named ContactSphere, was built in a rented office above a bakery in Meridian City. By 2016, ContactSphere had been rebuilt and relaunched as Vertex CRM, marking NovaTech's first major commercial success. The company has grown steadily since, expanding into analytics, workplace AI assistants, and secure cloud storage.

### 1.2 Key Facts

|                     |                                                                   |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Founded             | 2011                                                              |
| Headquarters        | Meridian City, Delmara                                            |
| Number of Employees | 1,240 (as of the most recent headcount audit)                     |
| Mission Statement   | "To engineer intelligent tools that give people back their time." |
| Company Type        | Private, employee- and investor-owned                             |
| Primary Industry    | Enterprise software and applied artificial intelligence           |

### 1.3 Company Values

- **Curiosity** — We ask why before we build.
- **Integrity** — We tell the truth, especially when it is inconvenient.
- **Craftsmanship** — We take pride in the details others skip.
- **Ownership** — We treat every project as if our name is on it.
- **Kindness** — We assume good intent and act accordingly.

## 2. Company Products

NovaTech currently maintains four commercial products. Each product is developed and supported by a dedicated cross-functional pod drawn from Engineering, AI Research, and Product.

## Pulsar Analytics Suite

|                     |                                                                          |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>      | Real-time business analytics and anomaly detection for operations teams. |
| <b>Release Date</b> | March 14, 2018                                                           |
| <b>Target Users</b> | Mid-to-large enterprises with high-volume data pipelines                 |
| <b>Pricing</b>      | \$499 per month per workspace (billed annually)                          |

### Features:

- Live, auto-refreshing dashboards
- Automated anomaly detection with alerting
- Natural-language query bar ("Ask Pulsar")
- Exportable scheduled reports

### Unique Facts:

- Pulsar was internally codenamed "Comet" during development.
- Its pipeline processes an average of 2.3 billion events per day across all customers.
- It was NovaTech's first product to use the LumenCore language model for query parsing.

## Aurora Assistant

|                     |                                                                     |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>      | An AI virtual assistant that automates internal workplace tasks.    |
| <b>Release Date</b> | September 1, 2020                                                   |
| <b>Target Users</b> | Internal operations and administrative teams at mid-sized companies |
| <b>Pricing</b>      | \$19 per user per month                                             |

### Features:

- Automatic meeting summarization and action-item extraction
- Task routing to the correct team or individual
- Voice-command support
- Calendar and inbox triage

### Unique Facts:

- Aurora is built on NovaTech's proprietary LumenCore language model.
- It surpassed 40,000 active daily users in its fourth year on the market.
- Aurora's wake phrase during internal demos is "Aurora, take note."

## Vertex CRM

|                     |                                                                   |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>      | Customer relationship management for sales teams.                 |
| <b>Release Date</b> | June 5, 2016                                                      |
| <b>Target Users</b> | Small-to-medium sales teams (5–200 seats)                         |
| <b>Pricing</b>      | \$29 per user per month (Starter) / \$79 per user per month (Pro) |

### Features:

- Visual pipeline and deal-stage tracking
- Two-way email synchronization
- AI-based lead scoring
- Custom reporting dashboards

### Unique Facts:

- Vertex CRM is NovaTech's oldest surviving product, originally named ContactSphere.
- It has been renamed twice: ContactSphere (2011) to LeadTrail (2014) to Vertex CRM (2016).
- The Pro tier includes access to NovaTech's lead-scoring model, LumenScore.

## Halcyon Cloud Storage

|                     |                                                           |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>      | Secure, encrypted cloud storage for regulated industries. |
| <b>Release Date</b> | January 10, 2023                                          |
| <b>Target Users</b> | Healthcare and financial services firms                   |
| <b>Pricing</b>      | \$0.02 per gigabyte per month, minimum 500GB commitment   |

### Features:

- End-to-end encryption on all file transfers
- Full version history with 12-month retention
- Compliance vault for regulated document types
- Granular, role-based access controls

### Unique Facts:

- Halcyon uses NovaTech's proprietary "TripleLock" encryption scheme.
- It is certified compliant with the fictional GDS-7 Data Standard used in this handbook's scenarios.
- Halcyon is NovaTech's newest product and its first built entirely by the Solstice-adjacent Engineering pod.

## 3. Employee Policies

### 3.1 Work Hours

Core collaboration hours are 9:30 AM to 5:30 PM, local office time. Employees may choose a flexible start time between 7:00 AM and 10:00 AM, provided they complete an 8-hour workday.

### 3.2 Remote Work Rules

NovaTech follows the "Flex-3" hybrid policy: employees are expected to work from a NovaTech office 3 days per week and may work remotely for the remaining 2 days. Fully remote arrangements require written approval from a department head.

### 3.3 Leave Policy

|                           |                                                                          |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Paid Vacation Days</b> | 24 days per calendar year                                                |
| <b>Sick Leave</b>         | 10 days per calendar year                                                |
| <b>Wellness Days</b>      | 5 additional days per calendar year, for mental health or personal reset |
| <b>Parental Leave</b>     | 18 weeks paid, for either parent                                         |

### 3.4 Work-From-Home Allowance

New employees receive a one-time home office setup stipend of \$600, plus an ongoing \$40 per month home-office allowance added to payroll.

### 3.5 Learning Allowance

Every employee receives an annual learning allowance of \$1,200 to be used for courses, books, conferences, or certifications relevant to their role. Unused balances do not roll over to the following year.

### 3.6 Promotion Requirements

- Minimum of 12 months in the current role.
- A rating of "Meets Expectations" or higher across two consecutive performance cycles.
- A formal nomination submitted by the employee's manager.
- Review and approval by the relevant department head.

### 3.7 Performance Review Schedule

Performance reviews take place twice per year: the Spring Cycle (completed each April) and the Autumn Cycle (completed each October).

## 4. Departments

| Department  | Head                | Team Size | Current Projects                               |
|-------------|---------------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------|
| Engineering | Priya Nandakumar    | 310       | Project Orion, Project Atlas, Project Solstice |
| AI Research | Dr. Elias Whitfield | 85        | Project Orion, Project Nimbus                  |

| Department       | Head           | Team Size | Current Projects                 |
|------------------|----------------|-----------|----------------------------------|
| Product          | Farah Al-Sayed | 60        | Project Atlas, Project Meridian  |
| Marketing        | Tomas Reyes    | 45        | Project Meridian                 |
| Customer Success | Grace Okonkwo  | 120       | Project Nimbus, Project Solstice |

## Engineering

**Department Head:** Priya Nandakumar

**Team Size:** 310 employees

**Responsibilities:** Builds and maintains all NovaTech products; owns platform infrastructure and reliability.

**Current Projects:** Project Orion, Project Atlas, Project Solstice

## AI Research

**Department Head:** Dr. Elias Whitfield

**Team Size:** 85 employees

**Responsibilities:** Researches and develops the LumenCore model family and applied machine-learning features.

**Current Projects:** Project Orion, Project Nimbus

## Product

**Department Head:** Farah Al-Sayed

**Team Size:** 60 employees

**Responsibilities:** Defines product roadmap, prioritization, and cross-team strategy.

**Current Projects:** Project Atlas, Project Meridian

## Marketing

**Department Head:** Tomas Reyes

**Team Size:** 45 employees

**Responsibilities:** Owns brand identity, campaigns, and external communications.

**Current Projects:** Project Meridian

## Customer Success

**Department Head:** Grace Okonkwo

**Team Size:** 120 employees

**Responsibilities:** Manages onboarding, support, and renewal for all NovaTech customers.

**Current Projects:** Project Nimbus, Project Solstice

## 5. Internal Projects

### Project Orion (NT-OR-114)

|                 |                                                                                          |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Project Code    | NT-OR-114                                                                                |
| Team Members    | 18 members (Engineering & AI Research)                                                   |
| Technology Used | LumenCore v3, Kubernetes, PyTorch                                                        |
| Current Status  | In Development (Phase 2)                                                                 |
| Deadline        | March 31, 2027                                                                           |
| Objective       | Build a next-generation predictive analytics engine to power the Pulsar Analytics Suite. |

### Project Atlas (NT-AT-072)

|                 |                                                                                     |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Project Code    | NT-AT-072                                                                           |
| Team Members    | 12 members (Engineering & Product)                                                  |
| Technology Used | Go, PostgreSQL, React                                                               |
| Current Status  | Testing                                                                             |
| Deadline        | December 15, 2026                                                                   |
| Objective       | Rebuild Vertex CRM's pipeline engine to support enterprise-scale customer accounts. |

## Project Nimbus (NT-NM-053)

|                        |                                                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Project Code</b>    | NT-NM-053                                                                        |
| <b>Team Members</b>    | 9 members (AI Research & Customer Success)                                       |
| <b>Technology Used</b> | LumenCore v2, internal voice-recognition SDK                                     |
| <b>Current Status</b>  | Beta Launched                                                                    |
| <b>Deadline</b>        | January 20, 2027                                                                 |
| <b>Objective</b>       | Expand Aurora Assistant's voice-command capabilities to 12 additional languages. |

## Project Meridian (NT-MR-029)

|                        |                                                                                                |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Project Code</b>    | NT-MR-029                                                                                      |
| <b>Team Members</b>    | 7 members (Marketing & Product)                                                                |
| <b>Technology Used</b> | Internal analytics dashboard, Segment                                                          |
| <b>Current Status</b>  | Planning                                                                                       |
| <b>Deadline</b>        | June 1, 2027                                                                                   |
| <b>Objective</b>       | Launch a refreshed brand identity and customer portal ahead of NovaTech's 15-year anniversary. |

## Project Solstice (NT-SL-091)

|                        |                                                                                        |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Project Code</b>    | NT-SL-091                                                                              |
| <b>Team Members</b>    | 14 members (Customer Success & Engineering)                                            |
| <b>Technology Used</b> | Zendesk API, internal ticketing system "HelpForge"                                     |
| <b>Current Status</b>  | In Development                                                                         |
| <b>Deadline</b>        | September 30, 2026                                                                     |
| <b>Objective</b>       | Build a self-service customer knowledge portal to reduce support ticket volume by 30%. |

# 6. Company Events

| Event                    | Date                        | Location                         | Description                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| NovaTech Annual Summit   | October 8–9, 2026           | Meridian City Convention Center  | Company-wide all-hands event featuring the CEO keynote, department showcases, and the annual Craftsmanship Awards.             |
| Hack the Nova            | May 15–16, 2026             | HQ Innovation Lab, Meridian City | A 48-hour internal hackathon open to all departments, with winning teams receiving development resources to pursue their idea. |
| AI Research Symposium    | July 22, 2026               | Meridian City                    | A one-day symposium featuring LumenCore model updates and invited external speakers on applied AI.                             |
| Wellness Week            | March 2–6, 2026             | All NovaTech offices             | A week of workshops, fitness challenges, and mental-health sessions available to all employees.                                |
| New Hire Orientation Day | First Monday of every month | Headquarters, Meridian City      | A recurring onboarding day for all new employees, covering company history, tools, and policies.                               |

## 7. Frequently Asked Questions

### **Q: When was NovaTech Innovations founded?**

A: NovaTech Innovations was founded in 2011.

### **Q: Where is NovaTech headquartered?**

A: NovaTech is headquartered in Meridian City, Delmara.

### **Q: How many employees does NovaTech have?**

A: NovaTech has approximately 1,240 employees, based on the most recent headcount audit.

### **Q: Who leads the AI Research department?**

A: Dr. Elias Whitfield leads the AI Research department, which has a team of 85 employees.

### **Q: How many employees work in the Engineering department?**

A: The Engineering department has 310 employees and is led by Priya Nandakumar.

### **Q: What is the project code of Project Orion?**

A: Project Orion's project code is NT-OR-114.

### **Q: What technology does Project Orion use?**

A: Project Orion uses LumenCore v3, Kubernetes, and PyTorch.

### **Q: What is the deadline for Project Atlas?**

A: Project Atlas is due on December 15, 2026.

### **Q: What is NovaTech's remote-work policy?**

A: NovaTech follows the "Flex-3" hybrid policy: 3 days in the office and 2 days remote per week. Fully remote arrangements require written approval from a department head.

**Q: What is the annual learning allowance?**

A: Each employee receives an annual learning allowance of \$1,200 for courses, books, conferences, or certifications.

**Q: How much does Halcyon Cloud Storage cost?**

A: Halcyon Cloud Storage costs \$0.02 per gigabyte per month, with a minimum commitment of 500GB.

**Q: How much does the Pulsar Analytics Suite cost?**

A: The Pulsar Analytics Suite costs \$499 per month per workspace, billed annually.

**Q: What was Vertex CRM originally called?**

A: Vertex CRM was originally called ContactSphere in 2011, then renamed LeadTrail in 2014, before becoming Vertex CRM in 2016.

**Q: How often are performance reviews conducted?**

A: Performance reviews happen twice a year: the Spring Cycle in April and the Autumn Cycle in October.

**Q: What is the work-from-home setup allowance for new employees?**

A: New employees receive a one-time \$600 home office setup stipend plus an ongoing \$40 per month allowance.

**Q: Which departments are working on Project Nimbus?**

A: Project Nimbus is a joint effort between the AI Research and Customer Success departments, with a team of 9 members.

**Q: What is the objective of Project Solstice?**

A: Project Solstice aims to build a self-service customer knowledge portal to reduce support ticket volume by 30%, with a deadline of September 30, 2026.

**Q: When is the NovaTech Annual Summit held?**

A: The NovaTech Annual Summit is held October 8–9, 2026, at the Meridian City Convention Center.